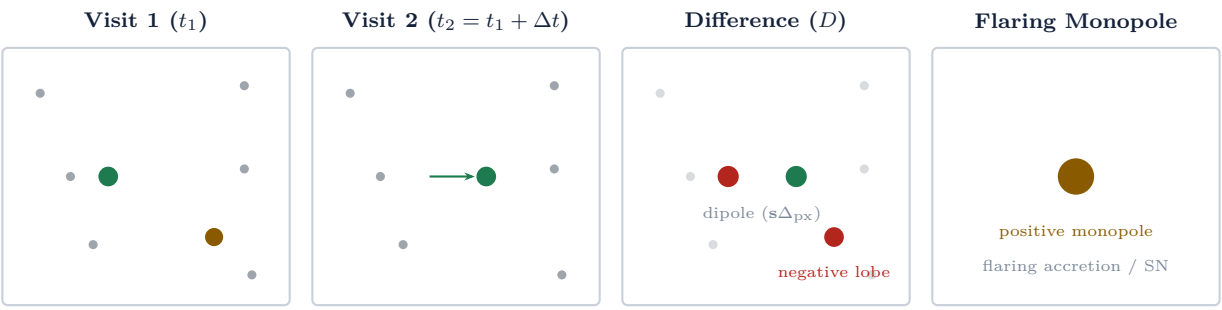


What survives raw subtraction, and why subtraction alone is not discovery:
Point-spread function variations between spacecraft roll angles, sub-pixel detector flat-field errors, astrometric jitter, and zodiacal gradients survive subtraction as structured residuals. These instrumental false alarms outnumber genuine astrophysical changes by up to 1000×. The scientific task is therefore statistical calibration and multi-wavelength triage.